MODULE 29 · DOMAIN 6 - STAKEHOLDER COMMUNICATION AND LIFECYCLE

Documentation, Handoff and the Lifecycle

The documentation set, what is different for a Claude system, runbooks, handoff that works without you, lifecycle phases and their outputs, continuity, and when to re-enter design.

DOMAIN 6 of 7 EXAM WEIGHT 14% MODULE 29 of 38

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Moving out? Leave the boiler manual, the stopcock location and the bin days. **Hand over what the next person needs when something breaks.**

Documents that explain the design

DOCUMENT	ANSWERS	MAIN READER
Architecture overview	What it is, and why it is shaped this way	Everyone
ADR log	Why this, and not the alternatives	Architects
Component contracts	Inputs, outputs, errors, limits	Engineers
Sequence diagrams	What calls what, in which order	Engineers, on-call

THE TIEBREAKER

Design documents answer why and how it fits together. They change only when the design changes.

Documents that run the system

DOCUMENT	ANSWERS	MAIN READER
Configuration with defaults	Every setting, its default, its safe range	Operators
Evaluation framework	How quality is measured, and on what set	Quality owner
Runbooks and on-call playbook	What to do when it breaks	Operations
Known limitations	What it cannot do, and must not be used for	Everyone

THE TIEBREAKER

Operating documents answer what to do. They change with every release, so they live with the code.

Known limitations, written so they protect people

- **What it cannot do:** "does not read handwritten letters".
- **Where quality drops:** rare complaint types, very long cases.
- **What it must not be used for:** "not for mortgage decisions".
- **How users are told:** in the interface, training and the guide.
- **Evidence:** each limitation links to its evaluation results.

> ON THE EXAM
>
> An undocumented limitation becomes somebody's incident. Write it where users will see it.

What a Claude system adds to the set

ARTEFACT	WHY IT MUST BE HANDED OVER
System prompts and Skills, versioned	Prompts are code; changes need history and review
Pinned model IDs per environment	Models retire; upgrades need a plan
Tool definitions and MCP configuration	Behaviour depends on names and descriptions
Reference evaluation set, with owner	Every change is judged against it
Guardrail and review thresholds	Risk decisions, with their owners
Token budgets and cost model	Cost alarms need a baseline

THE TIEBREAKER

If it changes Claude's behaviour, it is versioned, documented and handed over.

Architecture overview or implementation guide?

ARCHITECTURE OVERVIEW

What and why

- The system's purpose and boundaries
- Components and how they fit
- Key decisions, linked to ADRs
- Quality attributes and trade-offs
- For anyone who needs the picture

IMPLEMENTATION GUIDE

How to build and change it

- Set up an environment
- Add a tool, the agreed way
- Change a prompt safely, with evals
- Conventions, examples, review steps
- For the engineers extending it

THE TIEBREAKER

The overview helps people understand. The guide helps people change it without breaking it.

Anatomy of a runbook

SECTION	WHAT IT HOLDS
Trigger	The alert, and what it means
Impact	Who is affected, and how badly
Diagnose	Dashboards and queries, in order
Act	Safe steps, including rollback and fallback
Escalate	Who, and when
Verify and close	How to confirm it is fixed
Owner, last tested	Who maintains it, and when it was rehearsed

THE TIEBREAKER

Written for a tired person at two in the morning who did not build the system.

A runbook that works at two in the morning

AS WRITTEN

Portal slow

```
1 If the assistant is slow,
2 check the logs and fix it.
3 Restart if needed.
```

Which logs? Fix what? Restart what?

AS REVISED

Portal p95 error budget burn

```
1 Trigger: fast burn on p95 first token.
2 Impact: patients wait; calls rise.
3 Diagnose: latency by stage dashboard;
4   retrieval, tools, model, network.
5 Act: if a release in last 24 h, roll
6   back prompt version. If upstream,
7   enable degraded mode and banner.
8 Escalate: run lead after 30 min.
9 Verify: burn rate normal 1 hour.
```

A stranger can follow it, safely, in order.

THE TIEBREAKER

Every step names a place to look or a thing to do. Rollback and fallback are written down before they are needed.

The documentation sequence

01
Decide
ADRs, written as decisions are made.

02
Design
Overview, contracts, sequences.

03
Build
Implementation guide, config.

04
Test
Evaluation framework and set.

05
Prepare
Runbooks, limitations, playbook.

06
Hand over
Package, walkthrough, sign-off.

ON THE EXAM

Documentation is written alongside the work. Written at the end, it records memories, not decisions.

Keeping the documentation alive

- **Docs as code:** stored with the system, changed in the same pull request.
- **An owner and a review date** on every document.
- **Generated where possible:** configuration tables and contracts from source.
- **Rehearsed:** runbooks tested on game days, not just read.
- **Claude can draft updates** from the diff; a person reviews them.

> ON THE EXAM
>
> A document that disagrees with the system is worse than no document. It misleads with authority.

Handoff that works without you

01
Package
The full set, current and versioned.

02
Walkthrough
Design, decisions, limits.

03
Shadow
They watch you operate.

04
Reverse shadow
You watch them operate.

05
Game day
They handle a staged incident.

06
Sign-off
With open items owned.

ON THE EXAM

The test is not whether they received the documents. It is whether they can run and change the system without you.

The handoff sufficiency test

- **Build and deploy** without asking you.
- **Change a prompt** and know, from the evaluation set, whether it got worse.
- **Diagnose the likely incidents** from the runbooks alone.
- **Explain each major decision,** and when to revisit it.
- **State what the system must not be used for.**

> ON THE EXAM
>
> If any answer is "we would ask Corvane", the handoff is not finished.

Lifecycle phases, and what each produces

PHASE	PRODUCES
Discovery	Requirements, success criteria, baselines
Design	Architecture, ADRs, evaluation plan
Build	The system, implementation guide, reference set
Handoff	Documentation set, runbooks, a trained team
Monitoring	Dashboards, alerts, sampled reviews
Iteration	Evaluated changes, updated ADRs and docs

THE TIEBREAKER

Each phase is judged by what it hands to the next. Iteration feeds monitoring, and monitoring feeds iteration.

Continuity: what carries forward

- **The evaluation set,** kept and grown with real failures, so results stay comparable.
- **Baselines,** so every change is measured against the same starting point.
- **The ADR log,** continued, never restarted.
- **Lessons learned,** from blameless incident reviews, written down.
- **Success criteria,** unchanged unless renegotiated with the owner.

> ON THE EXAM
>
> A new team inherits history. Starting again from scratch throws away the ability to compare.

Iterate, or re-enter design?

SIGNAL	RESPONSE
A prompt tweak, new test cases, tuned thresholds	Iterate, gated by the evaluation set
A new user group, channel or regulation	Re-enter discovery and design
A new data class, such as health data	Re-enter design and compliance review
Model retirement or a new generation	Re-evaluate; redesign if criteria fail
A step change in volume, cost or latency	Re-enter design for capacity
The same failure, despite repeated prompt fixes	Re-enter design: the cause is structural

THE TIEBREAKER

Iteration changes behaviour within the design. A changed requirement, risk or scale changes the design.

Iteration done well

- **Small changes,** one at a time, each with a reason.
- **Evaluated before release** against the reference set.
- **Released gradually,** with a canary or comparison, and rollback ready.
- **Documents updated in the same change,** not later.
- **Failures fed back** into the evaluation set.

> ON THE EXAM
>
> Iteration without evaluation is drift. Iteration without documentation is the next team's mystery.

> Corvane is finishing Tallyhawk's support agent redesign. Tallyhawk's platform team will run it. Their lead says, "Just give us the repository. We can read code."

What should the handoff package include beyond the code?

A. A detailed README in the repository root, covering setup and deployment steps

B. The overview, ADR log, contracts, configuration, evaluation framework and set, runbooks, and known limitations

C. A recorded demonstration of every feature, for the platform team to watch

D. An executive summary deck for Tallyhawk's leadership, explaining the redesign

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What should the handoff package include beyond the code?

A. A detailed README in the repository root, covering setup and deployment steps

Setup only. No why, no runbooks.

B. The overview, ADR log, contracts, configuration, evaluation framework and set, runbooks, and known limitations

The full set: why, how, what to do, what not.

C. A recorded demonstration of every feature, for the platform team to watch

Shows features, not operation.

D. An executive summary deck for Tallyhawk's leadership, explaining the redesign

For a different audience.

THE SIGNAL

Code shows what the system does. It does not show why, how to judge a change, or what to do when it breaks.

> Mereside's agent-assist runbook for wrong suggestions says: "Investigate and fix."
>
> Overnight, the contact centre's on-call engineer did not build the system.

What should the runbook contain?

A. A link to the architecture overview, so the engineer understands the design first

B. The full system prompt, so the engineer can spot the problem in the wording

C. Trigger, impact, ordered diagnosis, safe actions with rollback and fallback, escalation and verification

D. The vendor's support number, since the model is the most likely cause

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What should the runbook contain?

A. A link to the architecture overview, so the engineer understands the design first
Understanding is not an action at night.

B. The full system prompt, so the engineer can spot the problem in the wording
Invites prompt edits at two in the morning.

C. Trigger, impact, ordered diagnosis, safe actions with rollback and fallback, escalation and verification
A stranger can follow it safely.

D. The vendor's support number, since the model is the most likely cause
Assumes the cause before diagnosis.

THE SIGNAL

Runbooks are written for a stranger at two in the morning: what it means, where to look, what is safe to do.

> Quillon's clinical informatics team has received the discharge-summary documentation set.
>
> Quillon asks how both sides will know the handoff is complete.

What should Corvane propose?

A. A reverse shadow and a staged incident, plus a prompt change judged on the evaluation set, all done by Quillon's team

B. A signed receipt confirming that every document in the set was delivered

C. A page count check against Corvane's standard handoff template

D. Six months of email support from Corvane, so questions can be answered as they come up

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What should Corvane propose?

A A reverse shadow and a staged incident, plus a prompt change judged on the evaluation set, all done by Quillon's team

Proves they can run and change it.

B A signed receipt confirming that every document in the set was delivered

Proves delivery, not capability.

C A page count check against Corvane's standard handoff template

Volume is not sufficiency.

D Six months of email support from Corvane, so questions can be answered as they come up

Postpones the test, and keeps the dependency.

THE SIGNAL

A handoff is proven by the receiving team operating and changing the system without you.

> Tallyhawk engineers keep breaking the support agent when they add tools.
>
> New tools overlap existing ones, and nobody runs the evaluation set before release.

Which document is missing?

A More ADRs, recording why each existing tool was originally added

B An updated architecture overview showing all the current tools and how they relate

C A runbook for incidents caused by newly added tools, with rollback steps for each one

D An implementation guide: how to add a tool, naming and description rules, required evals and review

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

Which document is missing?

A More ADRs, recording why each existing tool was originally added

History, not instructions for change.

B An updated architecture overview showing all the current tools and how they relate

The picture, not the procedure.

C A runbook for incidents caused by newly added tools, with rollback steps for each one

Treats the symptom after release.

D An implementation guide: how to add a tool, naming and description rules, required evals and review

How to change it without breaking it.

THE SIGNAL

The implementation guide tells engineers how to change the system safely.

> Mereside wants agent assist, built for trained advisers, to answer members directly in a new web chat.
>
> The team calls it a small extension: same model, same documents.

How should Corvane treat the change?

A Add a section to the system prompt for members, and release it to web chat

B Re-enter discovery and design: a new user group, new channel and new risks

C Add member questions to the evaluation set, and release if the score holds

D Release it to web chat with the same thresholds, and monitor closely

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

How should Corvane treat the change?

A Add a section to the system prompt for members, and release it to web chat

Treats a new risk as a prompt change.

B Re-enter discovery and design: a new user group, new channel and new risks

New users, channel and risk change the design.

C Add member questions to the evaluation set, and release if the score holds

Necessary, but not sufficient.

D Release it to web chat with the same thresholds, and monitor closely

Monitoring is not a design review.

THE SIGNAL

A new user group or channel is a design change, even when the model and documents are the same.

> Six months after handoff, Tallyhawk's new platform lead wants to replace the support agent's evaluation set.
>
> She plans to start a fresh one from scratch.

What should Corvane advise?

A. Start fresh, so the evaluation set reflects the new team's own priorities and products

B. Rely on live user feedback instead, since it is more current than any fixed set

C. Carry the existing set and baselines forward, grow it with real failures, and retire cases only with a reason

D. Have Claude generate a new synthetic set to replace the old one entirely, covering every tool

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What should Corvane advise?

A Start fresh, so the evaluation set reflects the new team's own priorities and products

Loses comparability with every past result.

B Rely on live user feedback instead, since it is more current than any fixed set

Feedback is late and biased.

C Carry the existing set and baselines forward, grow it with real failures, and retire cases only with a reason

Continuity keeps results comparable.

D Have Claude generate a new synthetic set to replace the old one entirely, covering every tool

Synthetic only misses real failures.

THE SIGNAL

Continuity: the evaluation set and baselines carry forward, so every change stays comparable.

> Anthropic announces the retirement of the model version behind Quillon's discharge summaries, on the first-party API.

Which two lifecycle actions should follow? Choose two.

A Pin the current version permanently, so behaviour never changes

B Switch to the replacement on the retirement date itself

C Wait for a cloud provider to publish its own schedule

D Run the evaluation set on the replacement well before the date, and re-baseline cost and latency

E Record the migration in a new ADR, and update the configuration and runbooks

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

Which two lifecycle actions should follow? Choose two.

A Pin the current version permanently, so behaviour never changes

Retired models stop working.

B Switch to the replacement on the retirement date itself

No time to fix failures.

C Wait for a cloud provider to publish its own schedule

Quillon uses the first-party API.

D Run the evaluation set on the replacement well before the date, and re-baseline cost and latency

Evaluate early, re-baseline.

E Record the migration in a new ADR, and update the configuration and runbooks

Decision recorded, docs current.

THE SIGNAL

A retirement is a lifecycle event: evaluate early, then record and document the change.

In five lines

- **Two halves:** documents that explain the design, and documents that run it.
- **Claude adds artefacts:** versioned prompts, pinned models, tools, evals, thresholds.
- **Runbooks** for a stranger at 2 a.m.; the implementation guide for safe change.
- **Handoff is proven:** reverse shadow, game day, a change judged by evals.
- **Carry evals forward;** new users, data, scale or retirement re-enter design.

COMING UP

Domain 6 complete. Next, Domain 7: Claude Code for teams.